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"ALL THE RANTS THAT FIT ON ONE SHEET"

The Citadel Chronicle

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VOL. XXI • ISSUE NO. 01 • BLOCK HEIGHT: **972,618** • OCTOBER 2026
1 SAT/vB • BANGKOK // PATHUM THANI EDITION

■ EXCLUSIVE DISPATCH • THE SAGE OF PATHUM THANI

FOUR HOURS ABOVE THE FLOODS: THE SAGE OF PATHUM THANI ON SURVIVING THE MARKETS

Sanjay Popli of AlphaMind sits down with Chaloke Sambandaraksa on mindset, risk engineering, and why the CDC curriculum teaches planetary cycles to know when to step away from the desk.



FIG 1. THE ALPHAMIND SESSIONS

Uncle Chaloke Sambandaraksa with Sanjay Popli (alphamind.network) inside the glass pavilion, looking across the flooded paddy fields of Pathum Thani.

I. THE FLOODED PLAINS

The interview began just after noon inside the glass pavilion in Pathum Thani, looking out across the drowned paddy fields still submerged from last month's monsoon floods. For four unbroken hours, Chaloke Sambandaraksa laid bare five decades of market survival. Sanjay Popli, co-founder of Cryptomind and host of AlphaMind (alphamind.network / @alphamindpodcast), sat down with the

"I do not seek the most profitable trading system," he stated with quiet, total conviction. "Chasing maximum profit is the amateur's fatal trap. I care only about the system that guarantees you cannot be destroyed."

II. SURVIVAL OVER PROFIT

For Chaloke and the CDC curriculum he founded, trading is fundamentally an exercise in risk engineering and psychological discipline. Money management is not an

"Survive first," he urged Popli. "When you master survival, the profits take care of themselves." In five decades navigating the 1987 crash, the 1997 Tom Yam Kung crisis, and the 2008 subprime contagion, he witnessed entire generations of chartists vanish because they mistook leverage for genius.

III. THE FIRST RULE

Before an entry is executed, the exit is already written. Survival requires knowing

THE MARKET REGIME: HARD MONEY IN AN UNEASY EMPIRE

LEAD EDITORIAL

Bitcoin enters late October trading north of $81,000 (Block 972,618), shrugging off spikes in US 10-year Treasury yields that would have sent traditional tech equities into a tailspin. Six months post-halving, the structural supply deficit is asserting itself. Daily exchange-traded fund inflows are systematically vacuuming up three to four times the 450 BTC daily miner emission. More significantly, sovereign and corporate treasury desks are moving past speculative accumulation into strategic balance-sheet fortification.

When Michael Saylor is pricing convertible debt offerings at negative effective yields and sovereign wealth entities in the Gulf are quietly bidding in the OTC shadows, price discovery is no longer about retail euphoria; it is an institutional game of musical chairs with an asset that cannot be printed.

Washington's sudden romance with Bitcoin has evolved from fringe campaign posturing into high-stakes geopolitical theater. Donald Trump's headline-grabbing pledges in Nashville—promising a US Strategic Bitcoin Reserve and the immediate defenestration of SEC Chairman Gary Gensler on Day One—have forced the Democratic apparatus into an awkward defensive pivot. But seasoned observers know the difference between campaign trail rhetoric and the entrenched machinery of the administrative state.

While political promises provide short-term momentum, the true catalyst isn't Washington's blessing; it is the mathematical inevitability of the US fiscal trajectory. With the US national debt compounding by a trillion dollars every 100 days, politicians aren't adopting Bitcoin out of ideological enlightenment—they are backing into it as the only lifeboat that doesn't leak.

Across the broader crypto circus, the mood is decidedly less celebratory. The so-called "altseason" remains MIA as a relentless conveyor belt of venture-backed Layer-1s and Layer-2s face catastrophic token unlocks. Billions in low-float, high-fully-diluted-valuation (FDV) tokens are dumping into illiquid retail order books, exposing the fundamental fiction of "governance tokens." Staking yields, once marketed as risk-free interest, are revealing themselves to be nothing more than self-referential dilution.

As Ethereum struggles under layer-2 fee cannibalization and Solana trades stability for speculative memecoin casino volume, capital is rotating relentlessly back toward the only asset with genuine monetary hardness. The market is slowly rediscovering what cypherpunks knew fifteen years ago: if a token requires a foundation, a roadshow, and a venture lockup schedule, it isn't cryptocurrency—it's an unregistered penny stock with an API.

OP-ED • GET OFF MY NODE

THE BITTER BIT: WHAT ON EARTH IS LEDGER THINKING?

By The Old Bastard

What on earth is Ledger thinking? Fresh off the total mayhem of the supply chain attack where someone added an LTE modem to certain wallets to capture seed phrases directly off the screen, which seems to be localised to a reseller in Malaysia, CryptoBilis and maybe another one in Europe, MediaMarkt, they are doubling down on complexity and launching what is basically an Android phone based hardware wallet.

Yes. Increasing the complexity of a device by untold multiples will definitely not be a problem in security and locking it down.

In computer science, they say one of the best features is KISS - Keep It Simple, Stupid.

The supply chain attack has cost users an estimated 80 to 90 million USD, with a single largest loss a cluster of 213 BTC (17 million USD). Worse their communication on the matter has been, limited to say the least. The website mentions it in a high level corporate PR spin kind of way and they are very much business as usual going forth.

"People simply don't care. All they care about is features," said Piriya Sambandaraksa, proprietor of Citadel Coffee. "Features, and ease of use." I suppose so.

Contrast that with the deep technical analysis and detailed down to the minute blow by blow forensic explanation of what happened to the Liquid hack whereby so-called whitehat hackers managed to mint 4,000 Liquid BTC out of thin air by reusing a cached hash, cashed it out via a peg-out partner and then said that they were the good guys and returned most of it, giving themselves 640 BTC as a reward. I think that hat needs a wash and it is certainly very dirty. Too dirty to be called white.

⚰️ MORGUE DISPATCH • REDEMPTION

The Strange Redemption of MagicalTux

Perhaps the greatest irony of the Ledger hack is that it has become the crescendo of MagicalTux's redemption arc. Yes, that guy who lost 850,000 Bitcoin due to sloppy coding and the transaction malleability bug is now suddenly a really cool OG bitcoiner who knows security.

In an ecosystem where catastrophes are forgotten every four years, surviving a decade in the arena transforms yesterday's villain into tomorrow's hardware security oracle.

🍺 TAVERN HOUSE RULES — CITADEL

1. Not your keys, not your coins.
2. Not your bare metal, not your server.
3. If it requires YAML, you buy the round.

FEATURE CONTINUATION FROM PAGE 1

The Supreme Discipline of Doing Nothing

FOUR HOURS ABOVE THE FLOODS (PART II): CYCLES & MACRO TIME

Then came the subject that distinguishes the CDC curriculum from dogmatic western academia: the integration of financial astrology into market timing. Rather than intraday crystal-gazing or fortune-telling, Chaloke employs ancient planetary cycles to gauge broad multi-year macro regimes—identifying which years carry favorable tailwinds, and which years demand that a disciplined trader step away from the desk entirely.

Knowing when *not* to trade is the highest discipline of all. For his students across Thailand, this cyclical timing is prized above all technical indicators. When the macro cycle turns hostile, no oscillator, Fibonacci retracement, or moving average crossover can save the over-leveraged.

"In a bear regime, your job is not to make money," Chaloke explained. "Your job is to preserve your capital and keep your mind clear. When the cycle turns, those who preserved their seed capital will inherit the market. Those who tried to force trades in bad years will have already liquidated themselves."

"People think trading is about continuous action," he added, adjusting his suspenders as the afternoon sun hit the flooded fields. "True trading is ninety percent waiting and ten percent decisive execution. If you do not have the patience to sit on your hands for twelve months while the storm passes, the market will gladly confiscate your tuition fees."

WITNESSING SINCE 1995 • NEWSROOM MORGUE

By Don Sambandaraksa

THE SEGREGATED WITNESS

Whiteboards with Benioff, Nasal Survival with Stallman, and Why Monty Named It After His Daughters

Most twenty-something tech commentators think computer history began the day they opened their first GitHub account in 2019. When you spent years on the technology beat at the *Bangkok Post*, however, you carry a slightly different set of mental scars. I still remember sitting in a Bangkok hotel suite with Marc Benioff back when his handlers had to pre-brief journalists with a marker and whiteboard just to explain what "Software as a Service" meant—long before SaaS mutated into the recurring-revenue hostage crisis we endure today.

Not long after, I interviewed free-software prophet Richard Stallman in person. You can read all the GNU manifestos you want, but nothing prepares a working reporter for the sheer olfactory force field of RMS at five paces. The man was brilliant, uncompromising, and smelled like he had been compiling the kernel inside a gym sock since 1984.

My favorite conversations, though, were always with the pragmatic builders like Michael "Monty" Widenius. Sitting down to hear the story behind `MySQL`—named after his older daughter, My—and how, even after selling it for a billion dollars, he couldn't stomach watching Oracle's corporate bureaucracy strangle his baby, so he forked `MariaDB` (named after his younger daughter, Maria) just to keep the code honest.

That is why institutional memory matters. When you have looked the architects of the modern stack in the eye—the idealists, the salesmen, and the craftsmen—you can spot a reheated dot-com grift from three blocks away. The acronyms change every five years; human nature and bad code stay exactly the same.

★ CLASSIFIED ADVERTISEMENT ★

CITADEL COFFEE SHOP

Notice: 99.9% Dark Roast Consensus

Miners have officially locked in today's Ethiopian Yirgacheffe. Any customer attempting to order oat milk will be partitioned into an isolated subnet.

HARD FORKS STRICTLY FORBIDDEN • PAY IN SATS

RIGHT SHIFT ADVISORY

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FROM THE MEMPOOL: 5-BIT BYTELINES

UNCONFIRMED CHAOS, MESH ROUTING & NEWSROOM SHORTS BY DON SAMBANDARAKSA

1. PRIVATISED GAINS

Your favourite Omni Consumer Products oCP patented a strain of holy basil. Thailand's favourite dish: Krapao in Pad Krapao. In a skit worthy of Robocop, oCP minions pointed out people can still plant and eat it, just not sell it. Kaset Uni noted newly developed strains were bred legally.

2. 30% EV TAX SHOCK

The government says it will put import taxes on foreign EVs to 30%. A level playing field is fine, but giving two months notice? The lack of regulatory stability does more damage to business confidence than any tax tweak could remedy.

3. OIL PRICED IN GOLD

Petrol went up this week, but priced in gold, crude is nearly 4x cheaper than the late 1970s. Peaking at >3g gold/bbl (~10 bbl/oz) then, today it trades at ~0.75g gold/bbl (~40 bbl/oz). To match late-70s hard money, crude would need to surge past $390/barrel.

4. CITADEL FLOODS

Floodwaters around the Citadel have receded. Roads remained just passable at peak. Lower-lying trees suffered, and the rotting black stagnant water smelled awful, but no mass dead fish. Far from normal, but we are drying out.

5. BITCHAT TOPS FRANCE

Thanks to social unrest in France, BitChat—the encrypted p2p messenger app based around Nostr and Bluetooth transport—is now number one on the French app store. When cellular towers are throttled and state censors watch telecom pipes, mesh routing thrives.

★ OFFICIAL CONFERENCE DISPLAY ★



BITCOIN THAILAND 2026

28–29 NOVEMBER 2026

📍 Samyan Mitrtown Hall, Bangkok

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🪦 OBITUARIES & RUGS — R.I.P.

In Memoriam: CloudSmart Home Hub (2021–2026). Bricked remotely on Friday after its parent company pivoted to generative AI. Survived by 40,000 plastic paperweights and a very smug guy using physical wall switches.

⚡ SOVEREIGN IMPRINT & NOSTR DISPATCH — ESTABLISHED 2026

Comments, critiques, corrections and on-chain tips to the Editor:

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